

Motorola Edge 50 Pro

Nearly perfect, but camera misses the mark

Motorola has ushered in its first Edge series launch of the year – the Motorola Edge 50 Pro.

Even though it has 'Pro' in its name, don't be confused by the nomenclature; this is the successor to last year's Motorola Edge 40 as indicated by the price and specifications. The phone packs some improvements and refinements across the board. Is this enough to make it stand out from the competition which includes popular phones such as the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Samsung Galaxy A35? Let's find out that and more in my detailed Motorola Edge 50 Pro review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

If you're looking for a stylish and opulent smartphone on a budget, look no further than the Motorola Edge 50 Pro. Everything from the soft vegan leather rear panel finish to the classy curvature of the phone's body screams luxury. The camera module juts out but the transition isn't harsh; rather it gently slopes into the protrusion. The Motorola branding sits smack in the middle of the rear panel and looks quite classy.

The phone is available in three gorgeous "Pantone-curated" colours – Luxe Lavender, Black Beauty, and Moonlight Pearl. The Moonlight White variant features a hand-crafted acetate finish. I got the Luxe Lavender colour variant for review and I absolutely adore its stunning pastel shade. Moreover, Motorola has even added a subtle scent to the box and phone which adds to the unboxing experience. There's also a colour-matched case and a 125 W charger in the retail box, which is brilliant.

Coming back to the Motorola Edge 50 Pro's design, the phone has an aluminium frame which, once again, is colour-matched to the rear panel – a nice touch. The phone is merely 8.19 mm thick and



weighs 186 g. While this is still extremely slim and lightweight, do note that it is a fair bit bulkier than the Moto Edge 40 which was merely 7.6 mm thick and weighed

only 171 g. Either way, the in-hand feel is exquisite – the curved design means that the phone is extremely comfortable to hold and the rear panel is quite grippy as well, giving me the confidence to ditch the case and flaunt the gorgeous back.

Additionally, the Motorola Edge 50 Pro is also rated IP68 dust and water-resistant. This means the phone is completely resistant to damage from dust and it can withstand full submersion in water up to 1.5 meters for up to 30 minutes.

DISPLAY

Motorola has heavily promoted the Motorola Edge 50 Pro as the first smartphone to feature a Pantone-validated display and Pantone-validated camera. While we will delve into the camera portion later in the review, let's talk about the display. The phone features a 6.7-inch pOLED

display with 144 Hz refresh rate and 1.5K resolution. It also packs HDR10+ support, 10-bit colour, and DCI-P3 colour. So, it's a fully loaded display.

In real-life usage, the display proved to be exceptionally immersive. The colour reproduction is very close to my Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra, which is excellent (when set to the Natural colour profile). Being a 1.5K resolution display, clarity is top-notch as well. Add to that excellent viewing angles, and you've got a display that leaves very little room for complaint. The curved screen did cause some accidental touches, but other than that, the display experience is stellar.

The phone's display is rated at 2,000 nits and in my testing, I got a reading of 1,278 nits using a LUX meter under bright sunlight, which is fantastic. The 144 Hz refresh rate screen also feels very smooth and can automatically dial down the refresh rate all the way to 60 Hz depending on the app you're using at the time. You also get Dolby Atmos-certified stereo speakers to compliment the display experience. These speakers sound full and warm; they also get pretty loud. All in all, there's no doubt in my mind that the Motorola Edge 50 Pro is one of the best smartphones under ₹35K for content consumption.

PERFORMANCE

The Motorola Edge series phones have never been champion performers. Can you get more powerful phones at the same price? Definitely. However, that doesn't mean that the performance isn't adequate for most casual users. The Motorola Edge 50 Pro houses the Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 processor. It comes with 8 or 12 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage. The storage speeds are a bit underwhelming compared to the competition such as the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Realme Narzo 70 Pro. I hope Motorola kits out their Edge phones with at least UFS 3.1 storage going forward.

Coming to benchmarks, the Motorola Edge 50 Pro showcases decent scores. In AnTuTu, it scores 831,690 which outperforms the Samsung Galaxy A35 and OPPO Reno11 but falls short of the cheaper POCO